

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman:	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	REMOVAL OF ASBESTOS PIPE	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L Likely	M Moderate	U Unlikely
H (1) (High level of harm)	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) (High)	1	1	2
M (2) (Medium level of harm)	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) (Medium)	1	2	3
L (3) (Low level of harm)	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) (Low)	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Planning 	Hazard: Inadequate planning Risk: Unsafe work site	1	Workers must ensure all tools and equipment outlined in Safe Operating Procedure for Cutting of Asbestos Cement Pipes with Reciprocating Saw are on hand Workers must ensure all personnel undertaking the AC repair are trained in CPCCE3014A Remove non-friable asbestos (under 10sqm)	Asbestos Removalist	2

Arrival at worksite, site assessment 	Inadequate planning Unsafe work site	1	1. Determine if the pipe or material the subject of work is ACM using the Asbestos register, where necessary. ** Where there is doubt, the pipe or material must be treated as ACM** 2. Calculate the area of AC pipe to be removed, using the table in the Safe Work Procedure 33 for Cutting of Asbestos Cement Pipework. Ensure saws are on hand. If greater than 10m2 a licensed contractor MUST complete the task. If under 10m2 only trained and competent persons to remove the asbestos containing material. 3. Place signs alerting to the presence of asbestos. 4. Erect barricades to delineate the asbestos removal area 5. PPE (minimum): As soon as you are ready to handle, or work on, the pipe or material: • Class P2 disposable respirator (class P3> can be used), • Safety glasses • Disposable overalls, • Safety gumboots. • Heavy-duty disposable gloves. 6. Wash your face and hands before each work break. 7. Do not consume any food or drink near exposed asbestos.	Asbestos Removalist	2
Cutting of Asbestos Pipe 	Dust Generation Asbestos Exposure Asbestosis	1	1. Lay large piece of geofabric underneath section of pipe to contain fibers and dust 2. Perform positive fit check on personal respiratory protection 3. Continuously dampen the pipe with surfactant (PVA 9:1 solution) prior to and during cutting process until completion 4. Cut AC pipe with a reciprocating saw, chain cutters or handsaw 5. The cut section of AC pipe shall be wrapped in the geofabric located underneath the pipe, by wrapping the fabric edges in on itself, ensuring all AC particles remain contained 6. Ensure safe manual handling techniques are used when lifting the cut section of pipe from the trench 7. Place wrapped pipe section in an asbestos waste bag 8. Make sure the bag is no more than half filled and remove excess air to reduce the risk of handlers inhaling dust. 9. Once you've filled the bag, twist the top of it tightly and fold the neck over in a gooseneck twist. 10. Seal the bag with duct tape to fully enclose the ACM inside.	Asbestos Removalist	2

			11. Place the first bag into the second bag and repeat the sealing procedure 12. Place the first bag into the second bag and repeat the sealing procedure. 13. If bag size is inadequate for the length of cut pipe, triple wrap the section of pipe in 10-micron foricon plastic, seal with duct tape and tape asbestos waste bag to each end of wrapped pipe 14. NOTE: No fragments of AC pipe material is to be left buried in the ground.		
--	--	--	---	--	--

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Decontamination of tools, equipment and PPE 	Exposure to Hazardous material Asbestos Exposure Public Health Environmental	1	Ensure PPE is worn for this process All tools and equipment must be fully dismantled and cleaned (wiped down) using the industrial wet wipes Using 1 surface of the wet wipe; refolded to expose a clean surface with each wipe to prevent recontamination All decontaminated tools and equipment must be stored in a sealable container (or double asbestos waste bags) with GHS Danger Asbestos label Exterior of storage container must be decontaminated using wet wipes and storage container placed outside of the contaminated work area <i>Decontaminate and remove PPE as outlined in Safe Operating Procedure for Cutting of Asbestos Cement Pipework</i>	Asbestos Removalist	2
5. Disposal of asbestos containing waste 	Exposure to Hazardous material Asbestos exposure Dust Generation Public Health Environmental	1	All double wrapped asbestos waste shall be securely and safely loaded onto an EPA approved Paneltec vehicle and transported directly from the worksite to be disposed of in an asbestos waste bin.	Asbestos Removalist	2

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen			Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat & Sun Ring	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment (P2 Mask)	Disposable Overalls – Hood On
Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.						
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP’s)		Vehicle Licenses (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)		Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required		Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management
First Aid certificate training		Manual Handling training		Fire Extinguisher training		Fatigue Management Training
A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.						
Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)						
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022						
Codes of Practice						
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020		Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020		Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018	
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018		Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020		Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019	
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018		Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020		WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018	
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020		Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018		How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2018	
Plant & Equipment for this activity						
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.						

WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING**Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS**

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.